

SHADRACH, MESHACH, AND ABEDNEGO

Furious, King Nebuchadnezzar ordered Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego to be brought before him.

“Is it true, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, that you do not worship my gods and refuse to worship the gold statue that I have set up? I am giving the second chance. When the big band strikes, you must get down to your knees and worship the statue that I have made. If you refuse, I will cast you into the fiery furnace. Who, then, can rescue you from my power?”

With firmed determination, they answered the king, “Our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from your hand and from the fiery furnace. There’s no doubt about it. But if he doesn’t, let it be known to you, O king, that we will not bow down nor worship the golden statue that you have made.”

Upon hearing this respond, the king’s rage grew stronger against them.

“I will grant your wish. Fire up the furnace seven times hotter, take them, and throw them into the fire. Let them be as examples to those who dare to defy me.”

The guards bound and dragged them violently to the furnace. They were thrown like trash into the bin. The flames from the furnace was so hot that it killed the guards who carried Shadrach, Meschah, and Abednego. The king was greatly satisfied to see the three young men in the fire. He was so sure they will last only a few seconds there. He didn’t expect what he’s about to witness.

Suddenly the king jumped up in alarm and said, “Didn’t we throw three men into the fire? But look! I see four men walking around freely, completely unharmed!”

Nebuchadnezzar approached the door of the furnace and called out, “Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, servants of the most high God, come out here!”

Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego walked out of the fire, completely unharmed. There wasn’t even a single hair singed, not even the smell of fire on them. Everyone gathered around them in complete amazement. There was no one who could withstand the fire, yet these three young men were standing before them without a single scorch mark on their clothes.

“Blessed be the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego! For He sent His angels and rescued His servants who trusted in Him. He did not abandon the people who put their hope and confidence in His power. He is greater than any gods known in this land. Therefore, hear these words my people... I, Nebuchadnezzar, issue this decree: Anyone, anywhere, of any color or race is to bow down and worship the God

of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. Those who break this decree will be ripped to pieces, limb from limb, and their houses will be torn down.”

Thus Nebuchadnezzar believed in the God of Heaven, for there had never been a god who can pull off a rescue like this. The people who witnessed this miracle realized that He who had done this great feat is indeed the only true God. Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego lived to testify the greatness of God who rescued them from the fierce fiery furnace.